



AI with Rav

Learn AI the way you actually think.



DAY 2 of 30

HACKATHONS

When you should NOT use AI agents

WHAT YOU'LL LEARN TODAY

- › What an agent actually is
- › The test that decides
- › Where agents genuinely help
- › Where they only add cost



When you should NOT use AI agents

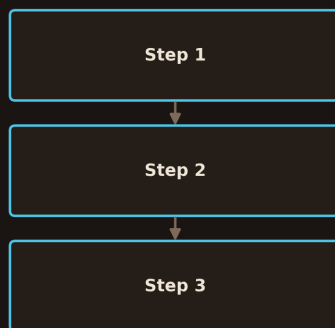
In One Line: If the steps never change, you do not need an agent. You need a function.

The honest definition

An "agent" is a model that **decides what to do next**.

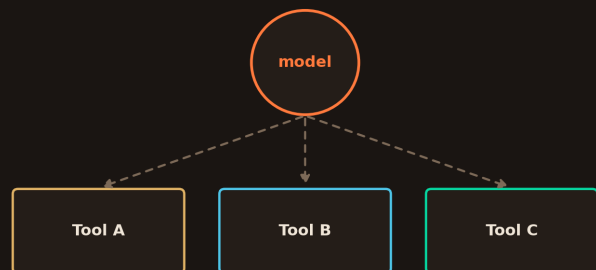
That is the whole thing. If your code always runs step 1, then 2, then 3 — that is a pipeline. Calling it an agent does not make it one.

PIPELINE — order fixed in advance



always the same path

AGENT — model picks the next step



chooses based on what came back

Only the right-hand case needs an agent

Same five jobs. Left: fixed order. Right: the model chooses. Only the right one needs an agent.

The test

Ask one question about your build:

"Could I draw the order of steps on paper before running it?"

If yes — it is a pipeline. Write the function. It will be faster, cheaper, and you will be able to debug it.

If no, because the next step genuinely depends on what came back — that is where an agent earns its cost.

My own app fails this test

Agentic Growth OS runs five agents in a fixed order, every single time. Audience,



copy, budget, campaign, score.

By the strict definition, that is a pipeline with LLM calls in it.

I said this out loud at the hackathon instead of hiding it. Naming your own limits reads as confidence, not weakness.

So when are agents worth it?

When the model must **choose**: which tool to call, whether the answer is good enough yet, whether to retry differently.

That judgement is the product. Everything else is a for-loop with extra billing.

Next video: why the numbers in your demo are probably fake — and the one-line check that proves it.

